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MUCHANGI PATRICK & ASSOCIATES

ADVOCATES OF THE HIGH COURT OF KENYA · DIGITAL TRUST ASSURANCE

EXECUTIVE BRIEF — NO. 002

Digital *Trust* in Kenya's SACCO Sector

What a SACCO's public digital footprint already reveals — and the questions a Board should be able to answer before a member, auditor or regulator asks first.

PREPARED FOR

SACCO Directors, CEOs, Company Secretaries, Compliance Officers and Senior Management

SECTOR

SACCO Governance

PUBLICATION

Knowledge Centre, July 2026

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This Executive Brief forms part of the Muchangi Patrick & Associates Advocates Knowledge Centre — published for educational and informational purposes as a contribution to Board-level governance discussion.

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Kenya's SACCOs have digitised faster than almost any other segment of the co-operative movement — mobile banking, member portals, digital loan products and electronic payments are now the default, not the exception.

Long before an auditor, regulator or investigative journalist ever requests internal documentation, a SACCO's public digital presence already tells a story about its governance maturity — a missing privacy notice or an undisclosed CCTV policy is not proof of non-compliance, but it is the kind of gap a Board should know about before someone else points it out.

This Executive Brief sets out what that public story typically looks like across the sector, and the questions a well-governed SACCO Board should be able to answer with confidence.

WHY THIS MATTERS

What a website reveals matters before a single document is reviewed.

Public Perception

What members, auditors and regulators can already see — long before any internal review begins.

Member Trust

Digital Trust strengthens confidence among members, regulators and stakeholders.

Organisational Resilience

Strong governance improves preparedness for incidents, regulatory change and digital transformation.

01

Digital Service Delivery

Mobile banking, internet banking and digital lending channels each raise distinct oversight considerations for the Board.

02

Privacy Transparency

Whether a Privacy Policy is published, current, and reflects what the SACCO actually does with member data.

03

CCTV Governance

Signage, retention periods and access controls — the governance wrapped around a camera, not just the camera itself.

04

Third-Party Technology Risk

Core banking systems, cloud hosting and payment integrations extend a SACCO's risk perimeter beyond its own walls.

05

Cybersecurity Governance

How cyber risk is identified, escalated and reported, and whether oversight sits with the Board or with IT alone.

06

Board Oversight

Whether Digital Trust metrics reach the boardroom in a form directors can meaningfully question and act upon.

QUESTIONS EVERY BOARD SHOULD BE ASKING

Seven questions to put to management this quarter.

- | | |
|----|---|
| 01 | Does the Board receive a regular Digital Trust report, not just an ICT update? |
| 02 | Is our Privacy Policy published, current, and reflective of actual practice? |
| 03 | Do we know, precisely, which third parties process member data on our behalf? |
| 04 | Is our CCTV governance — signage, retention, access — documented anywhere? |
| 05 | Could we detect and respond to a significant cyber incident within hours, not days? |
| 06 | Has our Digital Trust maturity ever been independently assessed? |
| 07 | If a member, auditor or regulator reviewed our website today, what would they conclude? |

ABOUT

Phoenix Digital Trust Assurance

Phoenix Digital Trust Assurance is an independent governance methodology developed by Muchangi Patrick & Associates Advocates to assist Boards and executive leadership in strengthening organisational governance across privacy, cybersecurity, information governance, technology governance, artificial intelligence, third-party risk and continuous improvement. The methodology promotes structured governance oversight rather than reactive compliance.

Muchangi Patrick & Associates Advocates

A Kenyan law firm specialising in Data Protection, Privacy, Digital Governance and Emerging Technology Law. Through its Knowledge Centre and Phoenix Digital Trust Assurance initiative, the firm publishes practical governance resources designed to assist Boards and executive leadership in navigating the evolving digital economy.

CONTINUE THE CONVERSATION

Book a Complimentary 10-Minute Digital Trust Gap Analysis

If this Executive Brief raises governance questions relevant to your organisation, we would be pleased to discuss them with you — current governance priorities, privacy and cybersecurity oversight, Digital Trust maturity, and practical next steps.

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